

The Measure Phase

Capture an honest baseline of how the process performs today, flaws and all.

The Core Idea

Measure is the second DMAIC step, built on one philosophy, you cannot improve what you do not measure. Management at our pizza shop might guess that rush hour traffic is the culprit, but Lean Six Sigma does not run on gut feelings. It runs on cold, hard data.

Build a Baseline

In this phase you establish a baseline, a numerical snapshot of how the process performs right now. You might track the exact temperature of each pizza out of the oven, the time it sits on the counter, and the minute it reaches the customer's door. You gather all of this without changing a single thing.

Why It Matters

Measuring without interfering gives you a totally honest picture of reality. Once you have a reliable baseline, you hold undeniable proof of the problem's true size and you are ready to start hunting for answers.

Remember this

No baseline, no proof, you cannot improve what you have not honestly measured.